



REPUBLIC OF KENYA

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18th March, 2024.

LAIKIPIA NORTH EDUCATION STAKEHOLDERS MEETING
REPORT HELD ON FEBRUARY AND MARCH 2024 IN LAIKIPIA
NORTH CONSTITUENCY

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

1.0 INTRODUCTION.....	3
2.1 Open plenary outcome.....	3
2.2 Challenges.....	3
2.2.1 Pupils Low entry behavior and poor transition	3
2.2.2 Absenteeism of learners and teachers.....	4
2.2.3 Retrogressive cultural practices	4
2.2.4 Lack of school feeding and poverty in the community	4
2.2.5 Shortage of teachers	4
2.2.6 Lack of schools supervisions and learners assessment	5
2.2.8 Uncommitted parents.....	5
2.2.9 Insecurity	5
2.2.10 Sand Harvesting Business.....	5
2.2.11 Inactivate and or uncommitted BoMs Members	6
2.3 Way forward or and recommendations.....	6
2.3.1 Counseling of learners in schools	6
2.3.2 Provision of the school feeding Programme	6
2.3.3 Well-structured monitoring of learners and assessment of school.	6
2.3.4 Training of school boards of management	6
2.3.5 Public Barraza to be conducted to deliberate school issues	6
2.3.6 Reaping value for money from NG-CDF and Partners.....	7
2.3.7 Developing schools libraries.	7
2.3.8 Recruitment of more teacher.....	7
2.3.9 Construction Teachers Houses.....	7
2.3.10 Construction of more ECDEs Centers and equipping.....	7
2.3.11 Promotion of religious activities in schools.....	7
2.3.12 Criminalization of outlawed cultural practices.....	8
2.3.13 Eradication of drugs.....	8
2.3.14 Establishment of special purpose education committee	8
3.0 Conclusion	8
LIST OF ATTENDANT	11

1.0 INTRODUCTION

This report provide the deliberations of the stakeholders meetings held in the four wards of Laikipia north constituency that targeted primary schools management and the constituency secondary schools management together with Ministry of education officials, Teachers service Commission officials, organization with education programmes and National Government administration. The report focused on performance, challenges, recommendation, conclusion and way forward drawn from the five respective stakeholders. The meetings were convened by Hon. Sarah Lekorere MP for Laikipia North Constituency in collaboration with IMPACT, Borana Conservancy Limited, Northern Rangelands Trust, Kenya Drylands Education Fund and Laikipia Conservancies Association members such as Loisaba, Olpejeta, Segera, Oljogi and Mpala Ranch Limited. Below are the scheduled date for the meetings that were held in the four ward and one for the secondary schools.

DATE	AREA/WARD	VENUE
23/2/2024	Mukogodo West	Twala
27/2/2024	Mukogodo East	Timau River Lodge
01/3/2024	Sosian	Olmoran Catholic Hall
0/3/2024	Segera	Endana Secondary
07/3/2024	All Principles	Beiza Hotel Nturukuma

2.1 Open plenary outcome

During the open plenary moderated by an educationist Madam Elizabeth Rikana. The main discussion brought about the following as the impediments or challenges for good performance in our schools. This includes Absenteeism of learners and teachers, retrogressive cultural practices, Lack of school feeding in school, shortage of teachers, and lack of schools supervisions, uncommitted parents and insecurity. Recommendation were also proposed and agreed for implantation to mitigate the poor performance in the schools.

2.2 Challenges

2.2.1 Pupils Low entry behavior and poor transition

It has been observe that low entry behavior (points) and Poor foundation from nursery school to primary school is a common trends in most of the learners, this bring a question to ask where our leaners come from. A few school appreciate the teaching process in the nursery school. This gives the grade one teachers a hard time to teach the learners the very basic learning that would have been taught in nursery schools. According to the meeting findings this has been contributed by disorganized learning in the nursery schools including poor and unqualified ECDE teachers, lack of teaching material and lack of supervision of ECDE teacher by the county government. This has necessitated the resolution to give authority the

Head teacher to have full control and supervision of learning progress in the catchment Nursery schools. The principals also spoke out that most of the learners whom they receive in form one do not comprehend little expression in English which is the most instrumental and learning language for all the subjects apart from Kiswahili.

2.2.2 Absenteeism of learners and teachers

Absenteeism of both learners and teacher has been identified as rampant in most of the schools, in most cases parent contribute a lot for the learners to be out of school. During market days all across the constituency student enrolment is low, this indicates that, most learners go to the market or they are assigned other domestic works for their parent to get a chance to go the market. Also during opening of the school majority of the learners do not report on the opening date. It's only Reteti primary that has express that any learner who fall to be absent and day of the term and fail to report on the opening date without the consent of the school administration, has to come with the parent to give an explanation. It has also been noted that head teachers are sometimes absent in schools and therefore not providing the required supervision and administrative support in the school. The main excuse sited is most head teacher are often engaged in meeting not justifiable or approved by the ministry of education. Some teachers are victims of drunkenness and this cause absenteeism in schools.

2.2.3 Retrogressive cultural practices

From the entire meetings, it has come out that retrogressive traditional practices are highly practiced in the constituency notwithstanding the fact that they are outlawed and presence of national government and law enforcer's officers are maximally available in the grassroots. The practices include female genital mutilation, early marriages and moranisim. This practices, mainly FGM and Moranisim make the learners feel they are adults irrespective of their ages. All this practices affect the learning of the learners since the learner become uncontrollable and ungovernable by the school administration.

2.2.4 Lack of school feeding and poverty in the community

For a long time primary schools in the constituency have not been having a sustainable food for lunch or even porridge in the school to the keep learners have concentration in their studies. Most of the parents that have their learners in all this public schools struggle even to put meals on the table and there some learner do not have any assured meal either in school or at home. Notably strives have been made to ensure at least a meal or a cup of porridge is available in some of the schools. Among the organization that have assisted in provision of food support across the constituency include NACONEC, Habitat, ACK, Loisaba, and County Government of Laikipia and Borana conservancy. Though the reliability has not been sustainable.

2.2.5 Shortage of teachers

Laikipia north constituency has an acute shortage of teachers either by design or by default. It's also noted that a number of teachers with disciplinary issues are often posted to Laikipia North. This include the notorious dunkers, frequently absentee's teachers, underperforming teachers and due for retirement head

of institutions. Mass transfers of teachers associated with the recent recruitments of teachers is a common trend that some newly recruited teacher meander their way out for transfers without completing the required time by the teacher service commission. Many schools in the constituency don't have substantive deputy head teachers.

2.2.6 Lack of schools supervisions and learners assessment

It's noted that the school supervision by the ministry have not been to the standard and not done in certain regular basis. This has created incoherent learning in the schools. The schools assessment is pivotal as per the intended purpose. Lack of enough resource and mainly fuel for the ministry vehicles have not been available at planned time for the assessment of the schools. The learners examination have not been standardize in most of the occasions. The main challenge is on learner's assessment in regards to Competency Based Curriculum (CBC), there no clear assessment mechanism and many teachers are yet to familiarizes accept the terms of the new curriculum (CBC). Poor pedagogy or the learning mechanism is poorly done by most teachers. Use of teaching aids materials, Innovation and passion altogether is need for the learner understand more and easy the topic taught.

2.2.8 Uncommitted parents

Many speakers in the deliberation expressed that majority of the parent have don't care attitude toward the learning of their children. Parent do not want to put little effort in supporting their children. This leaves the head teacher to face the challenges in the school alone that the parents can solve. Parent in most school don't attend parents meeting in the school. The ownership of the school is mostly left to head of the institution. Parent entertain indiscipline of their children and putting no efforts in correcting them.

2.2.9 Insecurity

The entire constituency is faced by insecurity. Banditry is the order of the day in the constituency the learners live with fear throughout the year. Every learner, community member and family is a victim directly or indirectly banditry insecurity. This had impoverish the community at large and it is felt in all spheres of live and thus some learners have dropped out of school due to lack school fees, eviction by bandits from their homes areas as well as their schools closed. Also wildlife insecurity is a challenge for learning across the constituency. Mainly elephants roams throughout the day between the school and the learners homes. This has made sometimes learner not to go to school, report late or even leave earlier. The most troublesome and dangerous are elephants and they have always made a lot destruction of properties in the school that ought to have contributed good learning environment in the schools. This include water tanks, perimeter fence and school gardens destructions.

2.2.10 Sand Harvesting Business

In the areas where sand harvesting is common school going children are engaging the business of sand scooping and in most cases the know money and drop out of school. It's also in this engage that most of the get exposed to drugs and eventually ruin their lives. The community and parent do not both much when their children bring them money from the sand business.

2.2.11 Inactivate and or uncommitted BoMs Members

It has also been agreed by the stakeholders that a number BoMs are inactive, most of them are elected and never attend their school meetings. Some member of the board also do not have the capacity and know how about their responsibilities. This make the dormant to make any contribution in the board meeting. The BoM eventually become irrelevant and only readily available for signing of cheques for the head of institution. The parent association representative do not understand their role and therefor no articulate parent meeting is conducted in the school.

2.3 Way forward or and recommendations

2.3.1 Counseling of learners in schools

The learners need to be counseled and guided while in schools to understand the importance of learning and the progressive stages that they have to undergo. Leaners need be told that after completing class eight is not the end of education, there is secondary education and university. This should be achieved by engaging mentors and motivational speakers. This can be alumnae of the school and other professionals that can be reached or accessed by the school management. Learners also need be counseled on drug abuse that are very rampant in the area.

2.2.2 Provision of the school feeding Programme

Provision of school meals by parents, county government M.O.E and other stakeholder will create a conducive learning environment. This helps in maintaining continuous enrollment of leaners in school and this will improves their performance. The schools management have been advice to make well use of what they to food in their school lands or generate income that can make them get food for their school. The school management to ensure harvesting of rain water in their school and make well use of it.

2.3.3 Well-structured monitoring of learners and assessment of school.

The stakeholder agreed that follow-ups of all leaners at all levels (ECDE to the University) monitoring evaluation of learning at school is very crucial and done as it's required. Regular examination should be provided to the learners to make the conversant on assessment mechanism. Each school to establish academic clinic day, this is to invite the parents to meet the learner's class teacher and be told about the performance of their learners. ECDE coordinators and the Head Teacher to regularly check and monitor education standards of the nursery school.

2.3.4 Training of school boards of management

The training of the school management should be an area of focus by the stakeholders. This is to capacity build the BoMs for them to perform to their responsibilities accordingly. Support for the training should be looked for the partners across the board. The BoMs shall perform the role actively and responsibly. This is promote good working relationship in the management and administration of the school.

2.3.5 Public Barraza to be conducted to deliberate school issues

Each of the school management to conduct public Barraza to capacity build parents on their roles in regards to education of their children and also training them the roles of BOMs since they are the key

stakeholders on management of schools. The discussion on absenteeism should highly discussed and discourage in the public Barraza's. Promptly report on absenteeism to the administration should be done to area chief and channeled up senior administration officers. Motivation of learner and teachers need be done to encourage those who are doing good to continue doing so and attract competition in among the learners and among teachers.

2.3.6 Reaping value for money from NG-CDF and Partner

The stakeholder agreed that the value of money invested by the government and donors must be realized through improved performance. Partners also need to diversify help. The donors need not to concentrate in one school only but try share the resources to other schools.

2.3.7 Developing schools libraries.

The stakeholders found it necessary to encourage reading culture in schools by starting libraries in school (This helps in improvement of language). The libraries can be improvised even under a tree can serve the learners for reading stories.

2.3.8 Recruitment of more teacher

The teachers service commission to ensure there are enough teacher in the schools. Teacher's student's ration should be interndem to the policy and legal requirements of the teachers service commission. The teacher service commission to ensure that mass transfer of teachers without replacement should be stop since it always create shortage of teachers in the constituency. The stakeholder also agreed that the notorious, drunken and indiscipline teacher should never be posted to Laikipia north constituency as verdict of disciplinary measure but instead keep those teacher in school that are close to TSC county headquarters office for their close monitoring by the employing authority. County government to recruit adequate and qualified ECDE teachers and facilitate the head teacher to conduct monitoring of learning in the ECDEs.

2.3.9 Construction Teachers Houses

The stakeholders found it important to ensure provision of houses for teachers in the school is given a priority. This is to ensure the security teachers is guaranteed and also close monitoring of learning is done by the teachers with ease. This will also promote morning and late evening learning in schools.

2.3.10 Construction of more ECDEs Centers and equipping them

The stakeholders found import for the county government keep focus on the construction of more ECDEs centers into standard and ensuring they equipped and the necessary materials area availed to support learning.

2.3.11 Promotion religious activities

The stakeholders noted going to church or mosque will promote nurturing off good behavior of the learners. However caution should exercise to ensure the parents and the school management understand well the type and kind service and religious entity the learners attend, since not are good.

2.3.12 Criminalization of outlawed cultural practices

Stakeholders indicated forthwith that FGM and early marriages are illegal and basically it's a defilement that MUST be reported for the perpetrators to be Arrest-Prosecute and Jail. Kangaroo courts must be put a stop by those local handling on criminal cases that clearly spelled out by the constitution of Kenya. Community need to start having a change of mindset and preach against negative cultural practices such as FGM, early Pregnancies and Marriages. The stakeholder also noted that some firms are engaging children in child Labour and those doing that will be apprehended and face full force of the law. The national government has given an assurance to support the schools to ensure law and order must be followed for benefit of quality education to the learners.

2.3.13 Eradication of drugs

Stakeholder agreed the supply of drugs is very high across the constituency. Prompt reports should be made on those who sell and supply illicit brews and drug and they should be apprehended. Community to help in containing the sale of illicit liquor e.g. Changaa. Record to be taken of Muguka supplies/sellers. No sand harvesting to be allowed after 6:00 pm and no school going children should be allowed in loading sand Lorries. The stakeholders noted that drug abuse are highly used while dwelling with sand harvesting in the scoping sites. Both learner, teachers and parent are victims to high level drugs accessible in the constituency. There should no leniency of teacher and learners using drugs in the learning institutions.

2.3.14 Establishment of special purpose education committee

The sub-county to establish a special purpose committee to work education mitigation and improvement. The committee shall bring together, MoE official, TSC official, Office of the MP, NGAO officials and the partners.

3.0 Conclusion

The stake holders agreed to work together for the improvement of education standards of our schools by harmonizing our resources, proper monitoring & evaluation of pupils. The stakeholders agreed to ensure that value for money is realized in our schools. It was also agreed that, education stakeholders meetings should be done on termly basis. The head teachers/principals promised to lead from the front by working well in their respective subjects; doing diligent supervision of teachers and learners and collaborate well with the parents, donors and other stakeholders to ensure the parents and government got a run for the money paid for learners and the teachers enjoyed their efforts through good results in national examination. Finally, the Member of Parliament promised to work hand in hand with schools as she has always done but such efforts should also be reciprocated through good performance.



Madam Rikana who was the main facilitator, Hon. Sarah MP Laikipia North Constituency and the national government officers at Twala cultural manyatta,



Madam Halake Tume Sub-county director education Laikipia East and Mukogodo East MCA Hon. Paul Shuel at Timau River lodge



Hon. Sarah Korere addressing Sosian Ward Education stakeholder at Olmorani catholic hall



Madam Elizabeth moderation the meeting session at Olmorani for Sosian stakeholders



DCC – Laikipia East Addressing stakeholders meeting at Endana Segera ward.



BOMs Chairpersons in group discussion at Beiza Hotel

LIST OF ATTENDANT

1. Hon. Sarah Korere - MP. Laikipia North
2. Mr. Partrick Muli - DCC Laikipia East Sub-county
3. Mr. Bernard Odino DCC Laikipia North Sub-county
4. Mr. Orata DCC Kirima Sub-county
5. Hon. Nicholas Lempaira – MCA – Mukogodo West
6. Hon. Paul Shuel – MCA – Mukogodo East
7. Hon. Eunice Moile – Nominated MCA
8. Mr. Nordin – SCDE Laikipia North Sub-county
9. Madam Melen – TSC Sub-county director Laikipia North
10. Madam Halake Tume – SCDE Laikipia East Sub-county
11. Mr. Gideon Ikungu – TSC
12. Madam Elizabeth Rikana – Educationist.
13. Mr. Gatheru – SCQASO Laikipia East- Sub-county
14. Mr. Augustine – SCQASO – Laikipia North Sub-county
15. Mr. Kimani – CSO Kirima Sub-County
16. Madam Joyce – CSO Central Divison
17. Peter P. Putunoi – Constituency Office Manager – Laikipia North Constituency
18. Mr. Evans Mohamed – ACC1 Laikipia North Sub-County
19. Mr. Mohamed – ACC Mukogodo Division Laikipia North Sub-county
20. Madam Salma – ACC Daiga Divison Laikipia East Sub-county
21. Madam Mukami – ACC Central Division Laikipia East sub- county
22. Hon. Peter Matunge – CEO Laikipia Conservancies Association
23. Mr. Paul Wachira – Operations and community manager - Loisaba Conservancy
24. Madam Nancy – Oljogi Community
25. Mrs. Jedidah Kamoire – Education Program Office – Borana Conservancy Limited.
26. Mr. Moses Lenaipa – NRT Education Program Director
27. Mr. Alex – LCA Communication Officer
28. Mr. Iyan Muiruri – Community Manager – Olpejeta Conservancy
29. Mr. Paul Gichuki – Representative for Nominated MCA Hon. Kamara
30. Constituency office staff and NG-CDF committee members across the Laikipia North Constituency.
31. Chiefs and assistant chief from Laikipia East, Laikipia North and Kirima sub-county
32. 24 Principal from the 24 secondary school from Laikipia north constituency together with their BoMs Chairpersons, PA Chairpersons and academic committee chairpersons
33. 78 Head teachers from the 78 primary schools from Laikipia north constituency together with their BoMs Chairpersons and PA Chairpersons